Among the easiest soups to prepare are those you process to a purée in a blender. The alternative is to use a food mill—this requires a little more effort, but the results are smoother.

puréeing

The secret to success with puréed soups is thorough cooking, so that the starchy ingredients that give the soup its body can be blended to a smooth purée. For that reason, always cook root vegetables and dried beans till they are extremely tender, but never overcook potatoes, or they will become glutinous and gluey. There is also a range of semi-puréed soups, in which some of the ingredients are blended to thicken the broth, while the rest are left whole for interest.

in a blender



1 Before blending, test the ingredients are really tender with a knife—they are only ready to purée when completely soft.



2 Blend the soup until you have a smooth consistency with no lumps. Do it in batches so you don't overload the machine.